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Web Development POE

Self-Reflective Report

Introduction

The Purpose of Evidence project required our group to design and develop a professional second-hand clothing website called Past Times using PHP and a database system. The website was created to allow users to buy and sell second-hand clothes through a user friendly online platform.

The system included three user roles namely Admin, Seller and Buyer. The Admin was responsible for managing users and approving or rejecting products submitted by sellers. Sellers could upload products and request approval before selling them. Buyers could browse products and make purchases.

The website included important features such as product listings, product categories, a search function, filters, a shopping cart, favourites and messaging for communication. The project allowed us to apply the knowledge we learned during the module including web development, database design, user interface design and teamwork.

Through this project I improved my technical skills communication skills and understanding of how real websites are developed.

Role in the Team

My main responsibility in the team was working on the PHP, developing website design and database structure. I focused on creating the backend functions and making sure the website looked professional. I helped design the user interface, create database tables, connect the website to the database and implement different features required by the system.

I contributed a lot to the development process by helping create the website structure and ensuring the database could store and retrieve information correctly. I also worked

on improving the design so that the website would be attractive user friendly and easy to use.

The group worked well together during the project. Each member had different strengths and responsibilities which helped us complete the project successfully. We communicated regularly to discuss progress assign tasks and solve problems.

Sometimes we faced challenges with deadlines and task completion. Some tasks took longer than expected and some features were difficult to implement. When problems came up we discussed them as a group and worked together to find solutions. We respected each other's ideas and focused on achieving our goal. This teamwork helped us complete the project successfully.

Research, Technology, and the Presentation of Information

Research played an important role in completing the project. During development I had to find information to help with technical and design tasks.

Scenario 1: Researching PHP and Database Functionality

One situation where research was needed was when developing the PHP functions and connecting the website to the database. I needed to learn how to create database connections retrieve data from tables and display information on web pages.

I used online tutorials like YouTube, documents the lecturer sent us and educational websites to learn the correct methods. This research helped me improve my coding skills and successfully implement important website functions.

Scenario 2: Researching Website Design and User Experience

Another situation where research was needed in result of creating a professional and attractive website design. On our first part of the POE we where required to research modern e-commerce websites and second-hand clothing platforms to understand current design trends and user experience principles.

This research helped me choose suitable layouts colour combinations navigation structures and product display methods. As a result our website became more attractive and easier for users to use.

Research helped me solve technical problems and ensured that the final website met professional standards. It also improved my ability to find reliable information and apply it in practical situations.

Personal Strengths and Weaknesses

Tasks That I Did Really Well

One task I performed well was developing the PHP functionality required for the website. I enjoyed working on the backend processes and making sure information could be stored and retrieved correctly from the database.

I also performed well when designing and structuring the database. I understood how different tables should connect and how data relationships should support the website's functionality.

Strengths That I Realised I Have

During this project I identified several personal strengths:

1. **Problem-Solving Skills** – I was able to identify technical problems and find solutions through research and practice.
2. **Creativity** – I enjoyed creating attractive designs and finding ways to improve the appearance and usability of the website.
3. **Technical Skills** – My knowledge of PHP databases and web development helped me contribute effectively to the project.
4. **Willingness to Learn** – When I faced difficulties I searched for information and learned new concepts to solve problems.
5. **Teamwork** – I worked well with my teammates shared ideas and contributed positively to discussions and decisions.

Tasks That I Did Not Do Well

Although I contributed a lot to the project there were some areas where I struggled. One challenge was implementing advanced website features. Some functions required more complex coding techniques than I expected. While I understood the basic concepts I sometimes needed help from teammates to complete certain features.

Another area where I struggled was the video presentation. Public speaking has always been challenging for me and I found it difficult to speak confidently while presenting the project. I became nervous when explaining technical concepts and sometimes struggled to express my ideas clearly.

Why I Did Not Perform Well in These Tasks

The main reason I struggled with some advanced features was that I had limited experience with certain programming techniques. Although I had a good understanding of PHP and databases some functions required extra knowledge that I was still learning.

For the presentation nervousness and a lack of confidence affected my performance. I am more comfortable working on technical tasks than speaking in front of an audience. This made it difficult for me to present information as effectively as I wanted.

How I Can Improve on My Weaknesses

To improve my technical weaknesses I plan to continue practising PHP development and working on personal projects. More practical experience will help me become more confident when implementing advanced features and solving difficult problems.

To improve my presentation skills I need to practise public speaking more often. Taking part in class presentations rehearsing beforehand and speaking in front of friends or family can help build my confidence.

I also believe that preparing well and learning presentation techniques will improve my communication skills.

By continuing to learn and practise I can improve these areas and become a better IT professional.

Conclusion

Overall the POE project was a valuable learning experience that allowed me to apply theoretical knowledge in a practical environment. I gained experience in PHP development database design website design research teamwork and problem-solving.

Even though I faced challenges with advanced features and presentations I learned important lessons that will help me in future projects. The experience improved both my technical and personal skills and gave me a better understanding of how professional web development projects are completed within a team.

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Web Development

Self-Reflective Report

Introduction

The Purpose of Evidence (PoE) project provided me with an opportunity to apply the knowledge and skills that I have gained throughout the course in a practical environment. Our group was tasked with designing and developing a professional second-hand clothing website using PHP and a database. The website needed to be visually appealing, user-friendly, and functional while meeting the requirements of different users. The system included three user roles: Admin, Seller, and Buyer. The Admin was responsible for managing accounts, approving or rejecting products submitted by sellers, and communicating with users. Sellers could request products to be listed and communicate through the platform, while Buyers could browse products, use filters and search features, add items to favourites, manage their carts, and purchase products. This project allowed me to gain practical experience in website planning, research, design, teamwork, and problem-solving while working towards a common goal.

Role in the Team

My primary responsibility within the team was conducting research and contributing to the design of the website. I focused on gathering information about modern e-commerce websites, second-hand clothing platforms, user interface design, and features that would improve the overall user experience. I researched various website layouts, colour schemes, navigation systems, and functionality to ensure that our website would be both professional and attractive to users.

One of my main contributions was helping the team identify the features that should be included in the website. Through my research, I suggested important features such as product categories, filters, a search bar, favourites, messaging functionality, and a shopping cart system. I also assisted in creating design ideas and ensuring that the website would be easy for buyers, sellers, and administrators to use.

The group dynamic was generally positive throughout the project. Team members communicated regularly and shared ideas openly. Everyone had specific responsibilities, which helped us divide the workload effectively. We supported one another when challenges arose and worked together to solve problems. Collaboration played an important role in the success of the project because each member brought different skills and knowledge to the team.

As with any group project, there were occasions when concerns and differences of opinion arose. One challenge involved deciding on the most suitable design for the website. Team members had different ideas regarding the appearance and layout of the system. To resolve these disagreements, we discussed the advantages and disadvantages of each suggestion and focused on what would best meet the project

requirements. Open communication and respect for each other's opinions helped us overcome conflicts and maintain a positive working relationship. When queries or concerns were raised, we addressed them through discussion and teamwork, ensuring that everyone remained informed and involved.

Research, Technology, and the Presentation of Information

Finding relevant and useful information was one of the most important aspects of my role in the project. Throughout the development process, I was required to conduct research to support decision-making and improve the quality of the website.

The first scenario involved researching website design trends and user experience principles. Since our goal was to create a professional and eye-catching second-hand clothing website, I needed to investigate how successful e-commerce websites were designed. I examined different clothing websites to understand their layouts, colour schemes, navigation systems, and product presentation methods. This research helped us identify features that would improve usability and make the website more attractive to customers. The information I gathered assisted the team in selecting an appropriate design that aligned with modern web development standards.

The second scenario involved researching the functional requirements of online shopping systems. I needed to understand how features such as search bars, filters, shopping carts, messaging systems, favourites, and account management worked within e-commerce websites. By studying existing examples and technical resources, I was able to provide useful recommendations regarding the implementation and organisation of these features. This research helped ensure that our website included the functionality required by buyers, sellers, and administrators.

Technology played a major role in both the research and development process. We used online resources, tutorials, and examples to improve our understanding of website design and development. The presentation of information was equally important because we needed to organise our findings clearly and communicate them effectively to other team members. Presenting information in a structured and understandable way helped the team make informed decisions throughout the project.

Personal Strengths and Weaknesses

Throughout the project, I identified several tasks that I performed well. One of my strongest contributions was conducting research. I was able to find relevant information

that helped guide the design and functionality of the website. I also performed well when analysing different website designs and suggesting ideas that could improve the user experience. Additionally, I contributed to discussions and collaborated effectively with my teammates to ensure that project objectives were achieved.

During the project, I realised that I possess several strengths:

1. **Research Skills** – I am able to gather information from different sources and identify what is relevant to a project.
2. **Creativity** – I enjoy generating ideas and exploring different design possibilities.
3. **Teamwork** – I work well with others and contribute positively to group discussions.
4. **Problem-Solving** – I can analyse challenges and assist in finding practical solutions.
5. **Adaptability** – I am willing to learn new concepts and adjust to changing project requirements.

Although I performed well in several areas, there were also tasks that I found challenging. One of the main difficulties I experienced was selecting the most suitable design for the website. Because there were many possible layouts, colour combinations, and feature arrangements, it was sometimes difficult to decide which design would best meet the needs of the users and the project requirements.

Another area where I struggled was confidently making final design decisions. I occasionally spent too much time comparing different options because I wanted to ensure that the chosen design would be effective. This sometimes slowed down my decision-making process.

In my opinion, I did not perform as well in these tasks because I lacked extensive experience in professional website design. While I understood the importance of creating an attractive and functional website, I was sometimes uncertain about which design choices would produce the best results. The wide variety of available design options also made the decision-making process more difficult.

To improve these weaknesses, I plan to continue learning about user interface (UI) and user experience (UX) design principles. I can improve by studying more professional websites, practising design skills, and gaining experience with design tools and frameworks. I also need to become more confident when making decisions by trusting my research and applying what I have learned. Seeking feedback from others earlier in the design process will also help me evaluate ideas more effectively and make better decisions.

Overall, I believe that the challenges I experienced were valuable learning opportunities. They highlighted areas where I can improve while also helping me develop new skills that will benefit me in future projects.

Conclusion

This PoE project was a valuable learning experience that allowed me to develop both technical and personal skills. Working on a second-hand clothing website provided practical exposure to research, website design, teamwork, communication, and problem-solving. My role focused primarily on research and design, and I contributed by helping identify suitable features and design concepts for the website. Although I experienced challenges when selecting the most appropriate design, the support and collaboration of my teammates helped us overcome these difficulties. Overall, the project strengthened my understanding of web development processes and demonstrated the importance of teamwork, planning, and continuous learning in achieving project success.

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Web Development

Self-Reflective Report: Past Times Website Project

Introduction

The Project of Evidence (POE) required us to work as a group to design and develop a professional second-hand clothing website called **Past Times** using PHP and MySQL. The website was required to include a database and various e-commerce features that would provide users with a functional and attractive online shopping experience. Some of the features included product categories, search functionality, filters, a shopping cart, favourites, messaging capabilities, and different user roles.

The website consisted of three main roles: Admin, Seller, and Buyer. The Admin was responsible for managing users and approving or rejecting products submitted by sellers. Sellers could request to sell clothing items and communicate with users, while Buyers could browse products and make purchases.

This project allowed me to gain practical experience in web development, databases, teamwork, problem-solving, and presentation skills. It also helped me understand how different technologies work together to create a complete website solution.

Role in the Team

My main contribution to the team was working with the MySQL database and assisting with the video presentation of the project. I was responsible for helping create and manage parts of the database structure that supported the website's functionality. This included understanding how data would be stored and retrieved for users, products, messages, and other website features.

I also played a major role in preparing and presenting the final demonstration video. I spent time learning how the website worked so that I could explain the different features clearly during the presentation. This involved understanding both the user side and the administrator side of the website.

The group dynamic was generally positive throughout the project. Team members worked together and shared responsibilities according to their strengths. When challenges arose, we supported one another and contributed ideas to find solutions. Communication was important because everyone had different tasks that needed to work together for the final product.

During the project, there were times when concerns and difficulties emerged, particularly when working with SQL and database-related tasks. Instead of allowing these challenges to create conflict, we communicated openly and asked for assistance from team members who had stronger SQL skills. This helped us solve problems more effectively and ensured that the project continued moving forward.

Working in a team taught me the importance of patience, cooperation, and listening to other people's ideas. By supporting one another and respecting each team member's contribution, we were able to successfully complete the project.

Research, Technology, and the Presentation of Information

Finding relevant and useful information was an important part of completing the project successfully.

The first scenario where I had to conduct research was when working with MySQL and SQL queries. I needed to understand how databases are structured, how tables are connected, and how data can be inserted, updated, and retrieved. To gain this knowledge, I researched online tutorials, documentation, and examples. This information helped me understand how the database would support the website's features and functionality.

The second scenario where I had to find information was while preparing for the video presentation. Since I was responsible for explaining the website, I needed to understand all the features and user roles. I researched best practices for website presentations and reviewed the functionality of each page to ensure that I could explain it accurately. I also gathered information from my teammates about the parts they developed so that I could provide a complete overview of the project.

Technology played a major role throughout the project. We used PHP for the website functionality, MySQL for database management, and phpMyAdmin for database administration. These technologies allowed us to build a dynamic website that could store and manage data efficiently. Through using these tools, I gained valuable practical experience that will benefit me in future projects and my career.

Personal Strengths and Weaknesses

Tasks That I Did Really Well In

One task that I performed well was assisting with the MySQL database. Although I initially found SQL challenging, I dedicated time to learning and understanding how databases function. This allowed me to contribute to the database aspect of the project.

Another task that I completed successfully was the video presentation. I spent time learning the website's features and understanding how the different roles interacted with the system. This preparation enabled me to explain the website clearly and professionally.

I also worked well with my teammates by communicating effectively and asking for assistance whenever I encountered difficulties. This helped ensure that problems were resolved quickly and that the project progressed smoothly.

Five Strengths That I Realised I Have

1. Willingness to Learn

I am willing to learn new concepts and technologies, even when they seem difficult at first. This helped me improve my understanding of MySQL and SQL.

2. Teamwork Skills

I work well with others and understand the importance of collaboration when completing group projects.

3. Persistence

When I faced challenges with SQL, I did not give up. Instead, I continued learning and seeking help until I understood the concepts better.

4. Responsibility

I took my assigned tasks seriously and made sure that my contributions were completed on time.

5. Communication Skills

I communicated regularly with my team members and contributed to discussions that helped improve the project.

Tasks That I Did Not Do Well In

One task that I struggled with was SQL programming. At the beginning of the project, I found it difficult to understand some SQL commands and how different database tables should be linked together.

Another challenge was the video presentation. Although I understood the content, I found it difficult to speak quickly and confidently during the presentation. I was concerned about maintaining a steady pace and ensuring that all important information was communicated within the required time.

I also found it challenging to remember every technical detail of the project because different team members were responsible for different sections of the website.

Why I Did Not Perform Well in These Tasks

I believe I struggled with SQL because I had limited experience working with databases before this project. Many of the concepts were new to me, which made the learning process more difficult.

Regarding the presentation, I naturally speak at a slower pace. This made me worry about timing and whether I would be able to cover all the required information effectively. Public speaking can also be stressful, especially when presenting technical information to an audience.

How I Can Improve These Weaknesses

To improve my SQL skills, I plan to spend more time practising database design and writing SQL queries independently. I would also like to complete additional database exercises and personal projects that require database integration.

To improve my presentation skills, I will practise speaking more often and rehearse presentations multiple times before presenting. Recording myself and reviewing my performance could help me identify areas for improvement. I also believe that gaining more presentation experience will increase my confidence over time.

To improve my technical understanding, I plan to become more involved in all aspects of future projects so that I gain broader knowledge of the technologies being used.

Conclusion

Overall, the Past Times website project was a valuable learning experience that allowed me to develop both technical and interpersonal skills. I gained practical experience with MySQL databases, teamwork, research, and presentations. Although I faced challenges with SQL and public speaking, these difficulties helped me grow and develop new skills.

Working together as a team enabled us to create a professional second-hand clothing website with multiple user roles and useful features. I am proud of what our team accomplished and believe that the experience has prepared me for future projects and professional opportunities.